

Open Letter to the Premier of Queensland

The Honourable David Crisafulli
Premier of Queensland

1 William Street
Brisbane QLD 4000

January 22, 2026.

Dear Premier Crisafulli,

RE: A Call to hold Imam Uzair Akbar accountable for his messaging.

We write to you out of deep concern for the safety of Queenslanders, and in particular the safety of the Jewish community.

On December 21, 2025, you stood in Brisbane City Hall and issued a defining statement. You rightly identified that *"It's the preaching of poison, it's the war of words"* that led to the Bondi Beach Massacre. You made a commitment to Queenslanders that their safety is paramount and that the incubation of hate would not be tolerated under your watch.

Sharing the stage with you that night was Imam Uzair Akbar, who also deplored violence at the time. In fact, in the media coverage that immediately followed, it appeared as though the Imam stands in solidarity against hate. However, since then, the Imam has preached with words of hate, directly focused on the Jewish community.

In a sermon released on his YouTube channel on 17 January, 2026 ([Episode 45: Are Muslims Pushing People Away?](#)), the Imam pivoted to preach a dangerous and conspiratorial message targeting Jews. Specifically, starting at the 9:30 mark, the Imam delivers remarks that can only be described as textbook antisemitism. During 90 seconds where he is engaging his live followers, he states:

- That Jews were the *"greatest enemies of the prophet of Allah"*.
- That this is still the case today.
- That *"we can see their sinister ideology, their sinister plotting, and planning till today"*.

Most alarmingly, he prefaced these remarks by acknowledging, "*so this is recorded - I have to be very careful*", demonstrating that he was fully conscious that his words were incendiary and likely to do some harm, yet he chose to speak them anyway.

Note that while other messaging of the Imam, during the same session (Ep45) speaks against community involvement in ISIS, and likewise against swearing at government leaders, the 90 seconds of hatred against Jewish people is inexcusable. For the Imam, to present such a message, three weeks after "standing in solidarity" with the Jewish community, is an indication to his community that hate is acceptable.

Premier, this is not a mere theological difference; it is the dehumanization of a specific group of Queenslanders. It is the radical teaching of hatred.

We cannot accept a standard where community leaders shake hands with the Premier by day and preach hatred by night. By standing on stage with him, the State of Queensland inadvertently validated his voice and boosted his platform. It is now the State's responsibility to clarify that it does not validate those who preach hate.

We are aware that your office would have not been aware of these words prior. We thus, respectfully call on you to:

1. Publicly condemn these remarks: by making it clear that the "preaching of poison" you warned against includes the rhetoric of Imam Uzair Akbar.
2. Prioritize Safety: Reaffirm to the Jewish community and the broader Queensland public that the safety of all citizens outweighs the desire to appease radical voices.

By allowing such hateful rhetoric to go unchecked, we fail not only the Jewish community and the broader Queensland community, but also the Muslim community, who are unfairly tainted by the extremism of a few.

We trust you will act swiftly to ensure your vision for a safe Queensland is upheld.

Sincerely,

**Daniel Eskin,
Brisbane Resident &
Community Advocate,
Queensland.**

**Hava Mendelle,
Director,
Minority Impact Ltd,
Queensland.**

**Dr. Yoni Nazarathy,
Associate Professor at
the University of
Queensland.**

Endorsed by the following Queenslanders, signed via a Google Form (Jan 20 - Jan 21):

1. R. Mendelle
2. D. Brazil
3. M. Rebibou
4. R. Ashri
5. S. Alazeez
6. L. Terret
7. H. Palevsky
8. Z. Qiao
9. S. Davidson
10. D. Miller
11. A. Rosenbaum
12. S. O. Kault
13. R. J. Abou-Raied
14. N. Koifman
15. L. Iseppi
16. C. N. Haggarty-Weir
17. D. Pedroso
18. N. Zee
19. D. Edeling
20. C. Ride
21. S. Mizrahi
22. J. W. Turier
23. R. Colldunberg
24. S. Ashri
25. J. Zee
26. E. Nazarathy
27. T. Baytelman
28. H. Zehavi
29. C. M. Peut
30. R. Mackenzie
31. G. Collins
32. D. Rothenberg
33. C. Rothenberg
34. C. M. Peut
35. S. London
36. S. London

37. N. Milns
38. D. L. Cameron
39. A. Ashri
40. D. London
41. K. Kelly
42. J. Chernilo
43. A. Rinon
44. E. Koifman
45. D. A. Skerman
46. U. Dobrovolski
47. N. Lavon
48. J. T. Venables
49. B. Levy
50. Y. Seroussi
51. A. Fowler
52. C. Nazarathy
53. A. Mizrahi